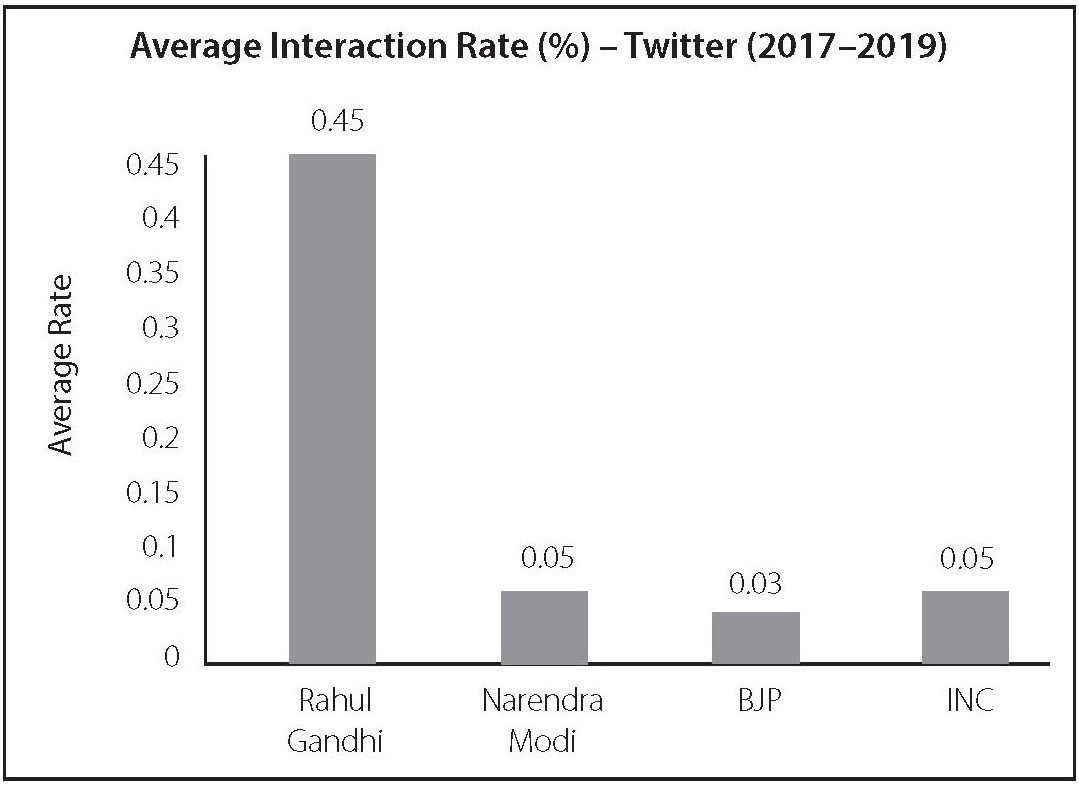


Source: CrowdTangle Intelligence Report Data analysed by Nalin Mehta, Rishabh Srivastava (31 May 2017–31 May 2019)

In each case, the BJP had a larger following, but these Congress handles were getting much more likes, retweets and replies on the tweets they were putting out on jobs, demonetisation and GST. They were able to rebrand themselves as a viable alternative to online audiences. Retweets and likes, because they represent how users are receiving messages, are a better way to track the efficacy of digital media messages than just the messages themselves or their volume. Sanjeev Singh has published some of the findings of this analysis of Twitter data in three separate research papers. They show a clear correlation between Twitter trends and the final electoral results in these states. Causation, though, is much more tricky territory and needs more in-depth studies.[35] Between late 2018 and February 2019, hashtags sympathetic to the Congress 'started trending on Twitter much more than those related to the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) and causes sympathetic to it'. Joyojeet Pal, professor at the University of Michigan and senior researcher at Microsoft Research, whose team studied 1,42,000 topics that